



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 26

MISSISSIPPI

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Mississippi's family courts and child-welfare system.

30

MISSISSIPPI FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
45 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 28
MONTHS MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 20, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 82

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

MISSISSIPPI AT A GLANCE.

Across 30 Mississippi families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 45 19 of 30 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$10,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 28 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 53.3% 23.3% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 30	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 2.4	REPORTING FAMILIES 19 of 30	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Mississippi families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02

THE COST OF MISSISSIPPI FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	19	\$10,000	\$51,203	\$972,858
Lost Wages	10	\$3,500	\$53,400	\$534,001
Other Court Fees	7	\$0	\$2,572	\$18,001
Therapy / Evaluations	12	\$1,302	\$2,959	\$35,505
Reunification Services	6	\$0	\$250	\$1,501
GAL Fees	14	\$3,400	\$7,072	\$99,001
Asset Loss	10	\$40,000	\$113,000	\$1,130,001
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$58,202	—	—

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		28	2.3 yrs
Mean months lost		26	2.2 yrs
Total across all families		366	30.5 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · MISSISSIPPI

Most families documenting in Mississippi are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Currently involved / "S...		15	50%
Case closed (within th...		4	13%
I am currently stuck in ...		3	10%
I am not currently in co...		1	3%
Case closed (more tha...		1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and ...		12	40%
Family Court Only		9	30%
CPS (Child Protective ...		6	20%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

Less than 6 months		10	33%
1 – 3 years		7	23%
5 – 10 years		5	17%
3 – 5 years		3	10%
1-3 years		2	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

Full Custody		9	30%
Children in Foster Care		7	23%
Visitation Only		6	20%
No Contact / Total Los...		5	17%
50/50 Joint		2	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Lamar		4	13%
Harrison country Missi...		4	13%
Washington		3	10%
Rankin		2	7%
Carroll		2	7%
Jackson		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Other: (Short answer)		6	20%
Family Court False Acc...		5	17%
Medical CPS (Medical ...		4	13%
High Conflict Divorce		3	10%
False Accusations CPS...		3	10%

05 PARENT VOICES — MISSISSIPPI

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Judge stated I would receive more financially because abuse was proven; opposite happened AND house given to husband

— JANICE

Taken my sons away (kidnapped/trafficked) Given them to abusers making them suicidal and not trusting anyone for help/hopeless and destroyed their physical and mental health

— DANA

my family has been placed into crisis due to their actions. We have been financially hurt and emotionally abused due to their negligence and false claims.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Emboldened an abuser to continue to abuse & oppress a mother & children after physical exodus. I've been disillusioned & no longer trust the system to help victims of abuse or represent the best interest of the children. I've learned the system is for abusers, not for their [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Me and my husband can't eat or sleep

— BENITEZ

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It has taken out souls we can't breathe it's like there drowning and I can't help

— ASHLEY JEAN

The system I was (finally) brave enough to contact, the one I held in such high esteem for protection and “doing what’s right,” has compounded the harm I was seeking safety from and punished me for trying to protect my children and myself.

— ALEX

My kids have lost faith in a system that was supposed to get help for their dad. GAL has sided with the abuser...their dad....we have proof. The kids have been humiliated by GAL going to school to pull them from class to talk to them...when she privately met with them multiple [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I followed the rules, told the truth, and still lost my son to a system that protects power over people

— ALEXIS

Separated a child from blood family, for rich family.

— MARIE

It has caused me so much emotional stress. I can't eat or sleep. I'm lucky to have a very understanding boss or I probably would have lost my job

— CHARLOTTE

Stripped a child from a Loving family. We are still stalked harassed bulluef. One sister not allowed to be apart of her sister life. Full custody of 1 child but not allowed to see the other

— KRISTEN

It take a big peace of me

— BENITEZ

The family court took an active, loving relationship away from me and my children, turning everyday life together into absence and loss. That separation has caused deep, lasting harm by breaking the bond that gave my children security and gave us our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



my child was taken for missing 5 unexcused absences at the height of the COVID 19 pandemic, my son is not the same boy. they knew they were wrong and they didn't care.

— ANTHONY

They took our daughter when she was 4 days old..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took our daughter when she was 4 days old..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has not only ripped my family apart it has taken away valuable time with my sons. it is placed a huge burden on my immediate family and has built a wall between my mother and sister and me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took everything from me I would have given willingly to keep my girls. My Name, My Career, My Education, My Church, My Community, My Possessions, My Friends, My Family.

— LACY

19 Mississippi parents submitted ranked quotes. 19 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/ms.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Mississippi report comes from Mississippi respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Mississippi — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 30 Mississippi families reporting here are not the universe of Mississippi families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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